Milestone Two: Cleaning, Testing, and Exploring Socioeconomic Well-Being in BC

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Introduction

This script uses the tidyverse to clean, test, and run exploratory data analysis with socioeconomic index data provided by BC Stats (BC Stats 2026; Teucher et al. 2021; Wickham et al. 2019).

Workflow Set-Up

```
library(bcdata)
library(tidyverse)
```

```
#bc_sei_data_raw <- bcdc_get_data("b-c-socioeconomic-index")
```

```
#write_csv(bc_sei_data_raw, "bc_sei_data_raw.csv")
```

After writing the dataset onto my computer and into the milestone two directory, I also saved a copy of the raw data into the 'data' directory in the Githib repository for safe keeping.

```
socioeconomic_index_raw <- read_csv("bc_sei_data_raw.csv")
```

Cleaning

First, I will get rid of columns that I do not need. The calendar year column does not make much sense for our analysis, as all of this data comes from 2023. The reason this column exists is because BC Stats also provides longitudinal data on SEI measures. For the purposes of this analysis, I will not be using longitudinal data.

```
cleaned_socioeconomic_index <- socioeconomic_index_raw |>
  select(-CALENDAR_YEAR)
```

Now, I will only include the municipalities of interest. For the purposes of this data story, I am only considering municipalities within the Metro Vancouver Region and the Greater Victoria Region.

```
cleaned_socioeconomic_index <- cleaned_socioeconomic_index |>
  filter(
    MUN_NAME_2021 %in% c(
    "Anmore", "Belcarra", "Bowen Island", "Burnaby",
    "Coquitlam", "Delta", "Langley", "Lions Bay", "Maple Ridge",
    "Metro Vancouver A", "New Westminster", "North Vancouver",
    "Pitt Meadows", "Port Coquitlam", "Port Moody", "Richmond",
    "Surrey", "Vancouver", "West Vancouver", "White Rock", "Central Saanich",
    "Colwood", "Esquimalt", "Highlands", "Juan de Fuca (Part 1)",
    "Juan de Fuca (Part 2)", "Langford", "Metchosin", "North Saanich",
    "Oak Bay", "Saanich", "Sidney", "Sooke", "Victoria", "View Royal"
  )
)
```

In the dataset, some municipalities are named twice because they contain sub-regions or districts. It is important that we give these better identifiers so that we can be more precise in our analysis.

```
cleaned_socioeconomic_index <- cleaned_socioeconomic_index |>
  mutate(
    MUN_NAME_2021 = case_when(
    CSD_UID == "5915002" ~ "City of Langley",
    CSD_UID == "5915001" ~ "Township of Langley",
    CSD_UID == "5915020" ~ "Electoral Area A (UBC)",
    CSD_UID == "5915051" ~ "City of North Vancouver",
    CSD_UID == "5915046" ~ "District of North Vancouver",
    CSD_UID == "5917054" ~ "Juan de Fuca (Part 1, Shirley, Jordan River,
```

```
    Malahat)",
    CSD_UID == "5917056" ~ "Juan de Fuca (Part 2, Port Renfrew)",
    TRUE ~ MUN_NAME_2021
  )
)
```

Let's also rename the columns

```
cleaned_socioeconomic_index <- cleaned_socioeconomic_index |>
  rename(
    Municipality = MUN_NAME_2021,
    Average_Age = AVERAGE_AGE,
    Population_2023 = POPULATION_ESTIMATE,
    Total_Index = TOTAL_INDEX_0_100,
    Socioeconomic_Index = SEI_INDEX_0_100,
    Economics = ECON_0_100,
    Education = EDUC_0_100,
    Health = HEALTH_0_100,
    Community = COMMUNITY_0_100
  )
```

Now, lets make it so that the index data only goes up to two decminal points.

```
index_decimal <- 2

cleaned_socioeconomic_index <- cleaned_socioeconomic_index |>
  mutate(
    across(
      c(
        Total_Index,
        Socioeconomic_Index,
        Economics,
        Education,
        Health,
        Community
    ),
    round, digits = index_decimal
  )
)

cleaned_socioeconomic_index |>
  as_tibble()
```

```
# A tibble: 37 x 10
   CSD_UID Municipality           Average_Age Population_2023 Total_Index
     <dbl> <chr>                        <dbl>           <dbl>       <dbl>
 1 5915001 Township of Langley           39.7          154103        56.1
 2 5915002 City of Langley               41.4           33626        46.8
 3 5915004 Surrey                        38.4          653040        52.0
 4 5915007 White Rock                    52.1           24294        51.0
 5 5915011 Delta                         41.8          120048        54.1
 6 5915015 Richmond                      42.1          235082        54.9
 7 5915020 Electoral Area A (UBC)        37.8           21150        60.0
 8 5915022 Vancouver                     40.9          732593        55.8
 9 5915025 Burnaby                       40.7          283588        56.0
10 5915029 New Westminster               40.7           88410        54.2
# i 27 more rows
# i 5 more variables: Socioeconomic_Index <dbl>, Economics <dbl>,
#   Education <dbl>, Health <dbl>, Community <dbl>
```

I also want to make the age variable an interger without decimal points.

```
age_decimal <- 0

cleaned_socioeconomic_index <- cleaned_socioeconomic_index |>
  mutate(
    across(
      c(
        Average_Age
      ),
      round, digits = age_decimal
  )
)

cleaned_socioeconomic_index |>
  as_tibble()
```

```
# A tibble: 37 x 10
   CSD_UID Municipality           Average_Age Population_2023 Total_Index
     <dbl> <chr>                        <dbl>           <dbl>       <dbl>
 1 5915001 Township of Langley             40          154103        56.1
 2 5915002 City of Langley                 41           33626        46.8
 3 5915004 Surrey                          38          653040        52.0
 4 5915007 White Rock                      52           24294        51.0
 5 5915011 Delta                           42          120048        54.1
```

```
 6 5915015 Richmond                       42          235082        54.9
 7 5915020 Electoral Area A (UBC)         38           21150        60.0
 8 5915022 Vancouver                      41          732593        55.8
 9 5915025 Burnaby                        41          283588        56.0
10 5915029 New Westminster                41           88410        54.2
# i 27 more rows
# i 5 more variables: Socioeconomic_Index <dbl>, Economics <dbl>,
#   Education <dbl>, Health <dbl>, Community <dbl>
```

Tests

I have two basic tests I want to run. The first is to make sure all variables are proper class. I am doing this by using the stopifnot function, which will stop running the code if it detects a variable that is not the proper class. The second is to make sure there are no negative values in the numeric variables. This code uses a logical if/else function to print out either 'passed' or 'stop' statements depending on whether number less than zero are found in each variable.

```
stopifnot(
  "Municipality must be a character" =
    is.character(cleaned_socioeconomic_index$Municipality),
  "Population must be numeric" =
    is.numeric(cleaned_socioeconomic_index$Population_2023),
  "Average age must be numeric" =
    is.numeric(cleaned_socioeconomic_index$Average_Age),
  "Total index must be numeric" =
    is.numeric(cleaned_socioeconomic_index$Total_Index),
  "SEI Index muste be numeric" =
    is.numeric(cleaned_socioeconomic_index$Socioeconomic_Index),
  "Community must be numeric" =
    is.numeric(cleaned_socioeconomic_index$Community),
  "Health must be numeric" =
    is.numeric(cleaned_socioeconomic_index$Health),
  "Education must be numeric" =
    is.numeric(cleaned_socioeconomic_index$Education),
  "Economics must be numeric" =
    is.numeric(cleaned_socioeconomic_index$Economics)
)
```

```
numeric_variables <- c(
  "Population_2023", "Average_Age", "Total_Index", "Socioeconomic_Index",
  "Community", "Health", "Education", "Economics"
```

```
)

for(
  SEI_var in numeric_variables) {
    if(any(cleaned_socioeconomic_index[[SEI_var]] < 0, na.rm = TRUE)) {
      stop(
        paste("Stop, there are negative values in the", SEI_var, "variable"))
 } else {
      message(
        paste("Passed, there are no negative values in the", SEI_var,
              "variable")
  )
 }
}
```

```
Passed, there are no negative values in the Population_2023 variable
```

```
Passed, there are no negative values in the Average_Age variable
```

```
Passed, there are no negative values in the Total_Index variable
```

```
Passed, there are no negative values in the Socioeconomic_Index variable
```

```
Passed, there are no negative values in the Community variable
```

```
Passed, there are no negative values in the Health variable
```

```
Passed, there are no negative values in the Education variable
```

```
Passed, there are no negative values in the Economics variable
```

Looks like all the tests passed and there are no negative numbers where there should not be.

Exploratory Data Analysis

Before making any graphs, I am gonna get a glimpe of the data and run some basic descriptive statistics to get a sense of central tendency and variability in the data.

```
head(cleaned_socioeconomic_index)
```

```
# A tibble: 6 x 10
  CSD_UID Municipality        Average_Age Population_2023 Total_Index
    <dbl> <chr>                     <dbl>           <dbl>       <dbl>
1 5915001 Township of Langley          40          154103        56.1
2 5915002 City of Langley              41           33626        46.8
3 5915004 Surrey                       38          653040        52.0
4 5915007 White Rock                   52           24294        51.0
5 5915011 Delta                        42          120048        54.1
6 5915015 Richmond                     42          235082        54.9
# i 5 more variables: Socioeconomic_Index <dbl>, Economics <dbl>,
#   Education <dbl>, Health <dbl>, Community <dbl>
```

```
tail(cleaned_socioeconomic_index)
```

```
# A tibble: 6 x 10
  CSD_UID Municipality                   Average_Age Population_2023 Total_Index
    <dbl> <chr>                                <dbl>           <dbl>       <dbl>
1 5917044 "Langford"                              38           55064        54.2
2 5917047 "View Royal"                            43           12578        54.4
3 5917049 "Highlands"                             43            2896        58
4 5917052 "Sooke"                                 43           16796        47.7
5 5917054 "Juan de Fuca (Part 1, Shirle~          50            5527        48.6
6 5917056 "Juan de Fuca (Part 2, Port R~          50             430        47.1
# i 5 more variables: Socioeconomic_Index <dbl>, Economics <dbl>,
#   Education <dbl>, Health <dbl>, Community <dbl>
```

```
summary(cleaned_socioeconomic_index)
```

```
    CSD_UID        Municipality        Average_Age    Population_2023
 Min.   :5915001   Length:37          Min.   :38.00   Min.   :   430
 1st Qu.:5915029   Class :character   1st Qu.:41.00   1st Qu.: 13162
 Median :5915062   Mode  :character   Median :42.00   Median : 24294
 Mean   :5915846                      Mean   :43.57   Mean   : 91549
 3rd Qu.:5917034                      3rd Qu.:46.00   3rd Qu.:100497
 Max.   :5917056                      Max.   :55.00   Max.   :732593
  Total_Index    Socioeconomic_Index   Economics       Education
 Min.   :46.79   Min.   :43.54       Min.   :33.72   Min.   :41.43
 1st Qu.:51.16   1st Qu.:52.29       1st Qu.:53.02   1st Qu.:49.59
```

```
 Median :54.87   Median :55.19       Median :55.66   Median :52.98
 Mean   :55.12   Mean   :55.39       Mean   :55.53   Mean   :53.56
 3rd Qu.:58.40   3rd Qu.:57.84       3rd Qu.:58.70   3rd Qu.:57.06
 Max.   :65.62   Max.   :66.46       Max.   :65.62   Max.   :70.13
     Health        Community
 Min.   :40.52   Min.   :44.70
 1st Qu.:50.20   1st Qu.:52.42
 Median :51.84   Median :53.91
 Mean   :52.19   Mean   :54.01
 3rd Qu.:54.86   3rd Qu.:56.54
 Max.   :64.36   Max.   :60.47
```

Bar Graphs

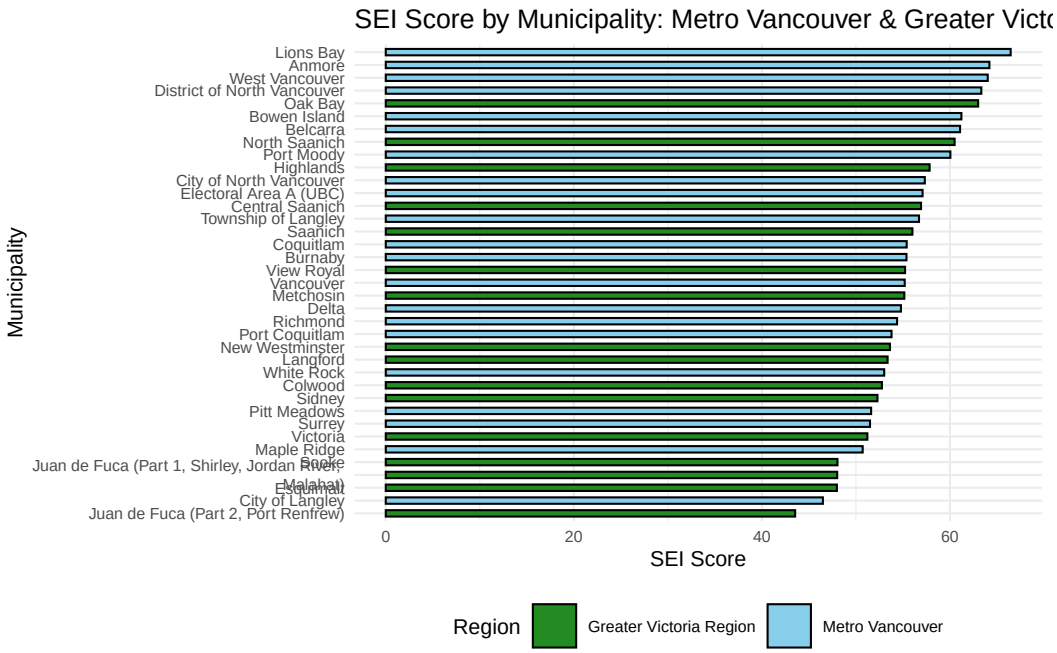
First, I want to create a bar graph that shows SEI score by each municipality. I also reordered the municipalities so that they are ordered from highest SEI score to lowest SEI score. I create a new variable that encapsulates all the municipalities in Metro Vancouver. Then, I use a logical if_else function to mutate the dataset so that the rest of the municipalities not included in Metro Vancouver are placed in Greater Victoria.

```
metro_vancouver <- c(
  "Anmore", "Belcarra", "Bowen Island", "Burnaby", "City of Langley",
  "City of North Vancouver", "Coquitlam", "Delta",
  "District of North Vancouver", "Electoral Area A (UBC)", "Lions Bay",
  "Maple Ridge", "New Westminister", "Pitt Meadows", "Port Coquitlam",
  "Port Moody", "Richmond", "Surrey", "Township of Langley", "Vancouver",
  "West Vancouver", "White Rock"
)


cleaned_socioeconomic_index |>
  mutate(
    Region = if_else(
      Municipality %in% metro_vancouver, "Metro Vancouver",
      "Greater Victoria Region"
      ),
    Municipality = reorder(Municipality, Socioeconomic_Index)
      ) |>

  ggplot(
    aes(
      x = Municipality, y = Socioeconomic_Index, fill = Region
```

```
    )
  ) +
    geom_col(
      colour = "black", width = 0.5
  ) +
    coord_flip() +
    scale_fill_manual(
      values = c("Metro Vancouver" = "skyblue", "Greater Victoria Region" =
      "forestgreen")
  ) +
    labs(
      title = "SEI Score by Municipality: Metro Vancouver & Greater Victoria",
      x = "Municipality",
      y = "SEI Score",
      fill = "Region"
  ) +
    theme_minimal(
      base_size = 8
  ) +
    theme(
      legend.position = "bottom"
    )
```

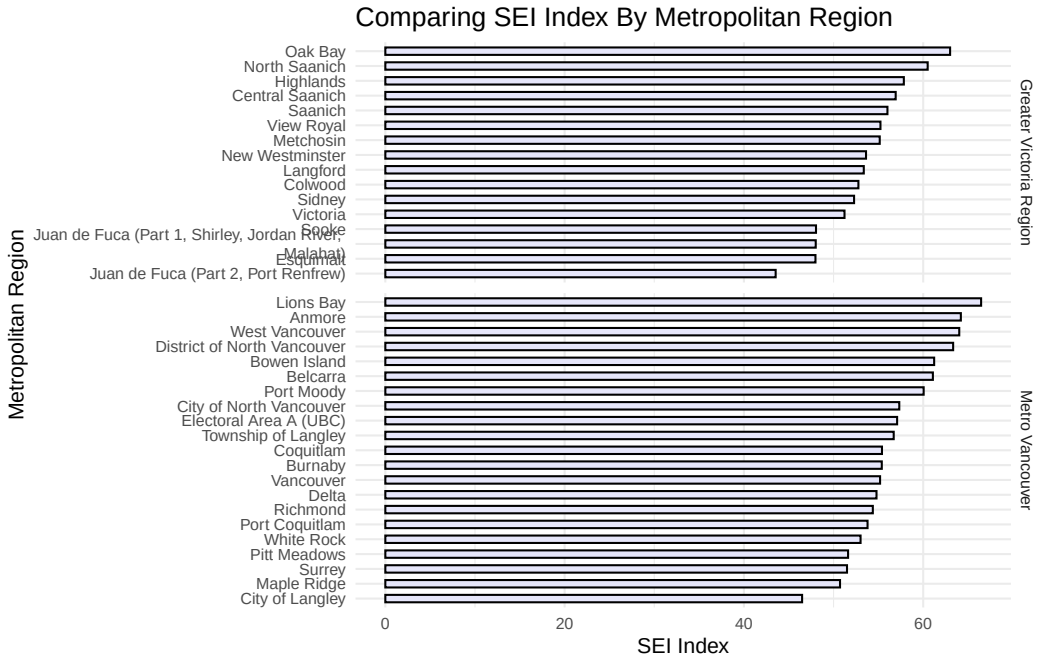


Alternatively, here is a bar graph that separates SEI scores by metropolitan region. This gives us an interesting peek into well-being index scores by metropolitan region.

```
metro_vancouver <- c(
  "Anmore", "Belcarra", "Bowen Island", "Burnaby", "City of Langley",
  "City of North Vancouver", "Coquitlam", "Delta",
  "District of North Vancouver", "Electoral Area A (UBC)", "Lions Bay",
  "Maple Ridge", "New Westminister", "Pitt Meadows", "Port Coquitlam",
  "Port Moody", "Richmond", "Surrey", "Township of Langley", "Vancouver",
  "West Vancouver", "White Rock"
)

cleaned_socioeconomic_index |>
  mutate(
    Region = if_else(
      Municipality %in% metro_vancouver, "Metro Vancouver",
      "Greater Victoria Region"
      ),
    Municipality = reorder(Municipality, Socioeconomic_Index)
      ) |>

    ggplot(
      aes(
        x = Municipality, y = Socioeconomic_Index
        )
      ) +
      geom_col(
        fill = "lavender", colour = "black", width = 0.5
      ) +
      coord_flip(
      ) +
      facet_grid(
        Region ~ ., scales = "free_y", space = "free"
      ) +
      labs(
        title = "Comparing SEI Index By Metropolitan Region",
        x = "Metropolitan Region",
        y = "SEI Index"
      ) +
      theme_minimal(
        base_size = 8
      )
```



Based on this graph, we can see that SEI index scores are relatively higher in the Metro Vancouver region than the Greater Victoria Region.

Box Plot

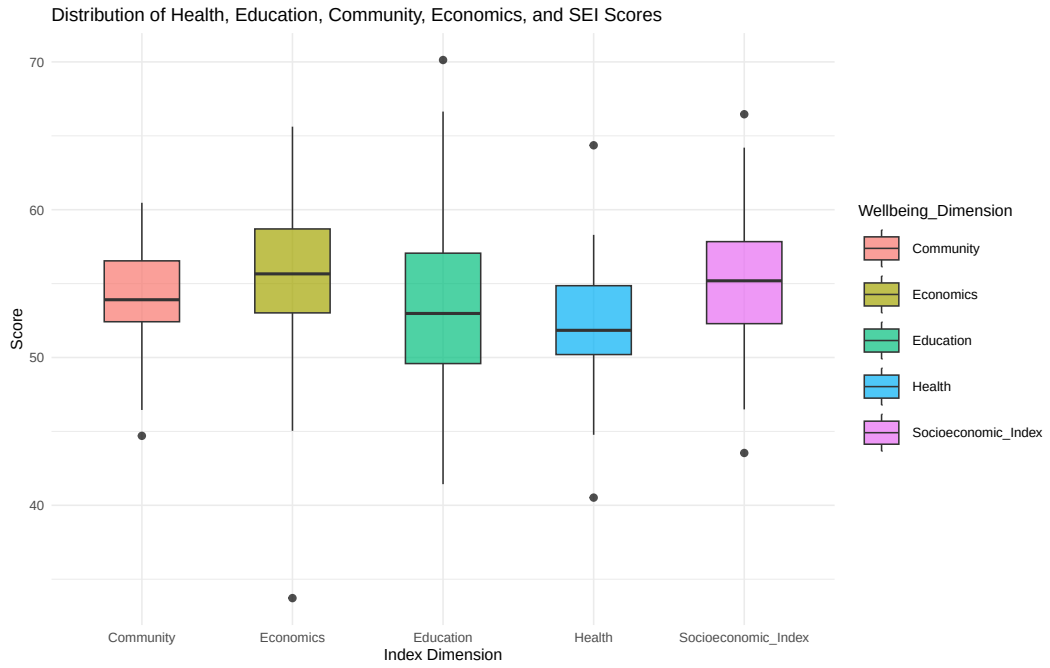
Lastly, we can create a box plot to see the distribution of scores across key numeric variables in my dataset. We will look at education, heath, community, economics, and SEI index.

First, I am going to use the pivot_longer function to reshape my data, the names_to argument makes a new column at the end of the dataset, inputting each dimension (Education, Heath, etc…) in a separate row within this new column for each municipality. The values_to argument prints the scores to each respective dimension into a new column. The reason I am reshaping the data is because it makes it easier for ggplot to differentiate each dimension. It creates five separate rows for each municipality, instead of each municiaplity only having one row containing all five dimensions.

```
cleaned_socioeconomic_index |>
  pivot_longer(
    c(
      Education, Health, Community, Economics, Socioeconomic_Index
      ),
    names_to = "Wellbeing_Dimension",
    values_to = "Score"
```

```
    ) |>

ggplot(
  aes(
    x = Wellbeing_Dimension, y = Score, fill = Wellbeing_Dimension
    )
  ) +
  geom_boxplot(
    alpha = 0.7, width = 0.5, outlier.color = "black"
  ) +
  labs(
    title = "Distribution of Health, Education, Community, Economics, and SEI Scores",
    x = "Index Dimension",
    y = "Score"
  ) +
  theme_minimal(
    base_size = 6
  )
```



Based on this graph, we can see that economics has the highest median index score, while health has the lowest. The median SEI index is floating around a score of 55 out of 100. It also seems that education has the largest variability within the 25th and 75th percentile and

community has the lowest variability within the 25th and 75th percentile. The black dots above and below each box represent outliers that I should revisit and check.

References

BC Stats. 2026. *BC Socioeconomic Index Methodology Report and Data*. Province of British Columbia. https://www2.gov.bc.ca/assets/gov/data/statistics/people-population-community/socio-economic/bcstatsnewslettermay2026socioeconomicindex.pdf.

Teucher, Andrew C., Sam J. Albers, and Stephanie L. Hazlitt. 2021. "Bcdata: An r Package for Searching and Retrieving Data from the b.c. Data Catalogue." *Journal of Open Source Software* 6 (61): 2927. https://doi.org/10.21105/joss.02927.

Wickham, Hadley, Mara Averick, Jennifer Bryan, et al. 2019. "Welcome to the tidyverse." *Journal of Open Source Software* 4 (43): 1686. https://doi.org/10.21105/joss.01686.